

Documentation versioning — the plan

Short version. Full reasoning and alternatives: `documentation-versioning.md`.

The problem

This site always shows the latest (main) state of each submodule. A customer on an older tagged release can't tell the docs have moved on, and has no way to see docs matching what they actually have.

The plan: a 3-way version switcher, only where it matters

A dropdown with three entries, shown **only on pages that come from a Robotiq-maintained submodule** (a tool's own page, its API reference, its synced guides):

Entry	What it shows
Latest	Today's behavior — every submodule at main. May include unreleased changes.
Stable	Every submodule at its own newest tag. A real, released state.
Previous versions	Not real docs — one static page: "for an older release, check that product's own tags," with a link per submodule.

Not shown on: product/ROS/Simulation/Other landing pages (they mix several tools), third-party tool pages (pyRobotiqGripper, community ROS packages, PyBullet, MuJoCo, GraspGen, ...), or docs/contribute/. None of those are backed by a submodule we tag-track, so there's nothing to version.

Why this and not full per-tag versioning

- **Bounded:** always at most 2 real builds (Latest, Stable) per tool, never one per tag. Adding submodules or tags never multiplies the work.
- **"Previous versions" costs nothing:** it's one static page, not a rebuild — we don't host every old release, we just point at it.
- **Covers the real, common case** (matching a *released* version) without building infrastructure for the rare one (matching an *old* release exactly).

What's new to build

- 1 A way to track each submodule's *newest tag*, separately from the existing main-tracking (Dependabot only does branches, not tags).
- 2 A small, versioned Docusaurus docs instance per Robotiq-maintained tool — this is also what scopes the dropdown to only those pages, for free.
- 3 One hand-authored signpost page for "Previous versions," listing each submodule with a link to its tags/releases.
- 4 A small "which version am I looking at" stamp on Latest and Stable pages.

Open before building

- How exactly do we track "latest tag" per submodule (new script, mirrors check-submodule-pins.js)?
- Do all submodules tag consistently enough (vX.Y.Z) to sort on?
- New-tool checklist (adding-a-tool.mdx) needs a step for the new per-tool versioned instance.